

GETTING STARTED

Overview

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Claude Code is an agentic coding tool that reads your codebase, edits files, runs commands, and integrates with your development tools. Available in your terminal, IDE, desktop app, and browser.

Claude Code is an AI-powered coding assistant that helps you build features, fix bugs, and automate development tasks. It understands your entire codebase and can work across multiple files and tools to get things done.

Get started

Claude Code runs on several surfaces: the terminal, IDE extensions, a desktop app, and the web. Choose one from the tabs below to get started. Most surfaces require a **Claude subscription** or **Anthropic Console** account. The Terminal CLI, VS Code, and JetBrains also support **third-party providers**.

[Terminal](#)
[VS Code](#)
[Desktop app](#)
[Web](#)
[JetBrains](#)

The full-featured CLI for working with Claude Code directly in your terminal. Edit files, run commands, and manage your entire project from the command line.

To install Claude Code, use one of the following methods:

[Native Install \(Recommended\)](#)
[Homebrew](#)
[WinGet](#)

macOS, Linux, WSL:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

Windows CMD:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.cmd -o install.cmd && install.cmd && del
```

If you see The token '&&' is not a valid statement separator , you're in PowerShell, not CMD. If you see 'irm' is not recognized as an internal or external command , you're in CMD, not PowerShell. Your prompt shows PS C:\ when you're in PowerShell and C:\ without the PS when you're in CMD.

If the install command fails with syntax error near unexpected token '<' , a 403 , or another curl error, see [Troubleshoot installation](#) to match the error to a fix and for alternative install methods.

Git for Windows is recommended on native Windows so Claude Code can use the Bash tool. If Git for Windows is not installed, Claude Code uses PowerShell as the shell tool instead. WSL setups do not need Git for Windows.

 Native installations automatically update in the background to keep you on the latest version.

You can also install with **apt, dnf, or apk** on Debian, Fedora, RHEL, and Alpine.

Then start Claude Code in any project. Replace `your-project` with the path to a project directory on your machine:

```
cd your-project
claude
```

You'll be prompted to log in on first use. If you've set the `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` environment variable, Claude Code skips the login prompt and asks you to approve the key instead. That's it! [Continue with the Quickstart →](#)

What you can do

Here are some of the ways you can use Claude Code:

Automate the work you keep putting off

Build features and fix bugs

Create commits and pull requests

Connect your tools with MCP

Customize with instructions, skills, and hooks

Run agents in parallel and build custom agents

Pipe, script, and automate with the CLI

Schedule recurring tasks

Work from anywhere

Use Claude Code everywhere

Each **surface** connects to the same underlying Claude Code engine, so your repo's CLAUDE.md files, settings, and MCP servers work across all of them.

Beyond the **Terminal**, **VS Code**, **JetBrains**, **Desktop**, and **Web** surfaces above, Claude Code integrates with CI/CD, chat, and browser workflows:

WEBHOOKS INTO A SESSION

Start a task locally, continue on mobile	<u>claude --cloud</u> , then the <u>Claude mobile app</u>
Run Claude on a recurring schedule	<u>Routines</u> or <u>Desktop scheduled tasks</u>
Automate PR reviews and issue triage	<u>GitHub Actions</u> or <u>GitLab CI/CD</u>
Get automatic code review on every PR	<u>GitHub Code Review</u>
Route bug reports from Slack to pull requests	<u>Slack</u>
Debug live web applications	<u>Chrome</u>
Build custom agents for your own workflows	<u>Agent SDK</u>

Next steps

Once you've installed Claude Code, these guides help you go deeper.

- [Quickstart](#): walk through your first real task, from exploring a codebase to committing a fix
- [Store instructions and memories](#): give Claude persistent instructions with CLAUDE.md files and auto memory
- [Common workflows](#) and [best practices](#): patterns for getting the most out of Claude Code
- [A harness for every task](#): how the Claude Code team uses [dynamic workflows](#) to orchestrate subagents at scale
- [Settings](#): customize Claude Code for your workflow
- [Troubleshooting](#): solutions for common issues
- [code.claude.com](#): demos, pricing, and product details

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